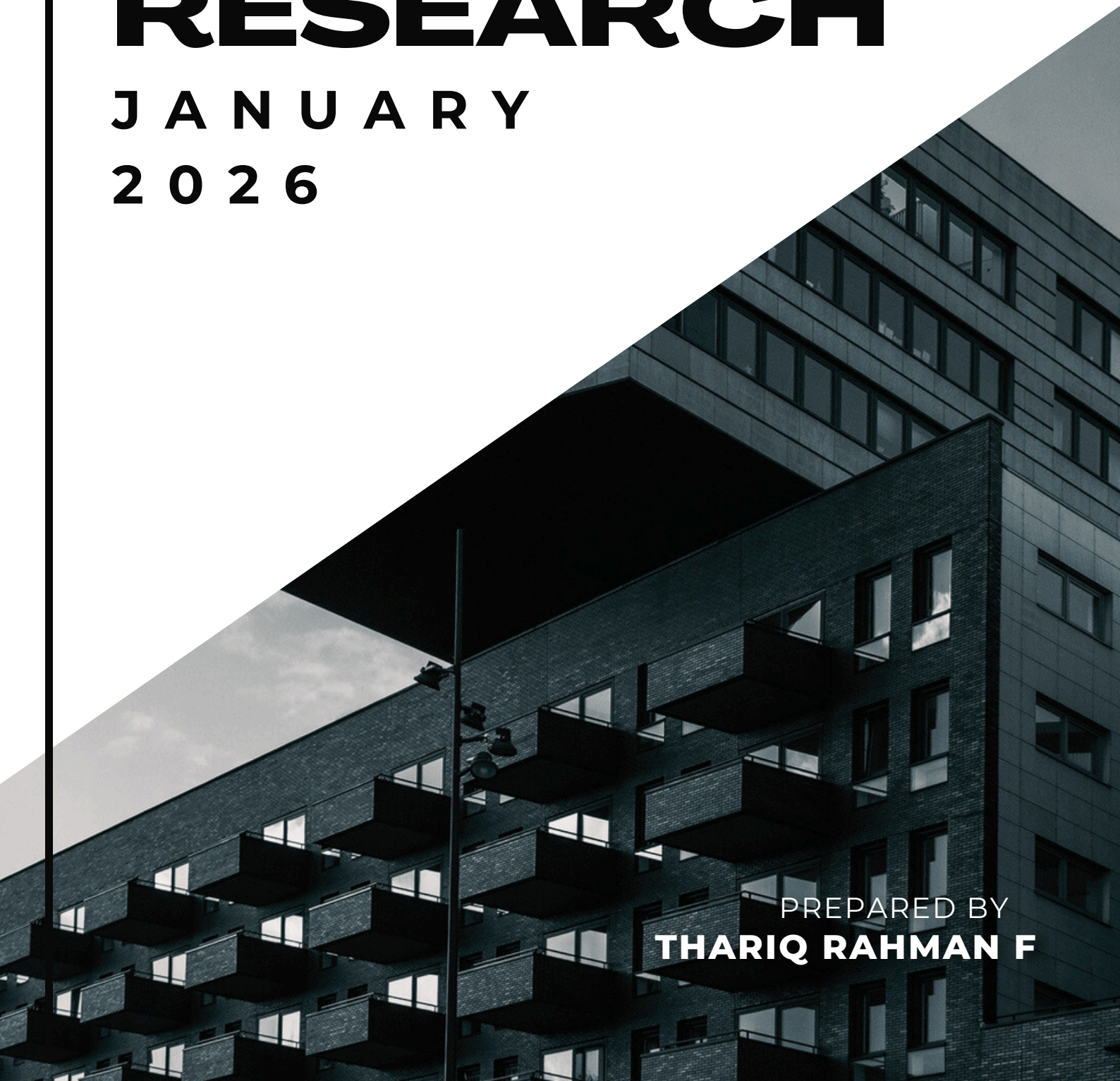
CRYPTO EXCHANGE
OUTLOOK

MARKET RESEARCH

JANUARY
2026



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Are We in an AI Bubble?

What is Ai Bubble?

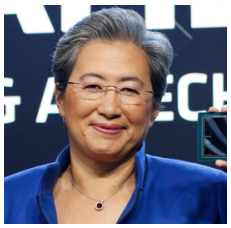
The AI bubble concern stems from soaring company valuations, massive infrastructure spending, and the circular nature of the AI ecosystem. While experts debate whether this "capex boom" is justified by the path to AGI or if it's an overextended market, the general consensus is that we are not in a full bubble yet.

However, the widening gap between high costs and actual returns suggests that while opportunities remain, maintaining a diversified portfolio is the smartest move for navigating this volatility.

The Expansionists

Jensen Huang ~ CEO NVIDIA

"I don't believe we're in an AI bubble. We're going through a natural transition from an old computing model based on general purpose computing to accelerated computing... AI has become good enough because of reasoning capability... it's now generating tokens and intelligence that is worth paying for."
Source : (Bloomberg TV)



Lisa Su ~ CEO AMD

"For those who are talking about a 'bubble,' I think they're being too narrow... look at this technology arc for AI over the next five years... AI has that potential. The bubble talk is completely wrong."
Source: (Time Magazine 2024)

Peter Thiel ~ VC Cofounder PayPal

"My macroeconomic placeholder is that it's going to keep going... There is no other vector of growth in our society, we would be out of our minds not to take it."
Source : (The Spectator Des 2025, Business Insider)

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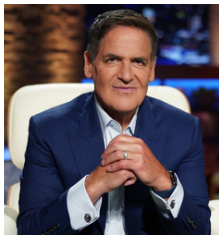
Eric Schmidt ~ Former CEO Google

"I think it's unlikely, based on my experience, that this is a bubble... It's much more likely that you're seeing a whole new industrial structure."
Source: (RAISE Summit Paris July 2025, Business Insider)



Mark Cuban ~ Entrepreneur

"Are we in a bubble? NO... Back in the dot-com era, tech slowed down. With AI, it's still accelerating. It looks like a bubble because it's capital-heavy — but it's not. We've barely scratched the surface."
Source: (Podcast Lex Fridman)

Cathie Wood ~ CEO ARK Invest

"In our view, an AI bubble is years away!"
Source: (ARK Invest 2026 Outlook, January 2026)

The Skeptics

Sam Altman ~ CEO OpenAI

"When bubbles happen, smart people get overexcited about a kernel of truth... Are we in a phase where investors as a whole are overexcited about AI? My opinion is yes. Is AI the most important thing to happen in a very long time? My opinion is also yes."
Source: (The Verge, Business Insider Des 2025)

Jeff Bezos ~ Founder Amazon

"This is a kind of industrial bubble... During bubbles, every experiment or idea gets funded. The good ideas and the bad ideas... But that doesn't mean anything that is happening isn't real. The benefits to society from AI are going to be gigantic."
Source: (Italian Tech Week Turin, 3 Okt 2025, CNBC)

Bill Gates ~ Cofounder Microsoft

"The value is extremely high, just like creating the internet... But you have a frenzy. And some of these companies will be glad... Absolutely, there are a ton of these investments that will be dead ends."
Source: (CNBC Okt 2025)

Ray Dalio ~ Founder Bridgewater Associates

"Where we are in the cycle right now is very similar to where we were between 1998 or 1999... There's a major new technology... But some people are confusing that with the investments being successful."
Source: (Financial Times Jan 2025)

Michael Burry ~ Hedge Fund Manager The Big Short

"Understating depreciation by extending asset life" is one of the great frauds of modern finance.
Source: (InvestorPlace Nov 2025)

Demis Hassabis ~ CEO Google DeepMind

"Some of this looks unsustainable... there are likely 'bubbles' forming in today's AI funding frenzy, particularly among early-stage startups raising money at huge valuations... and a correction is coming."
Source: (Google DeepMind: The Podcast, Des 2025)

Tim Draper ~ VC Investor

"There will indeed be a bubble bursting... OpenAI is the equivalent of AOL in the first internet wave."
Source: (Wawancara Business Insider, Oktober 2025)

Balanced Narrative

Mark Zuck ~ CEO Founder META

"If the models keep on growing in capability year-over-year and demand keeps growing, then maybe there is no collapse... There's definitely a possibility... The risk... is probably in not being aggressive enough rather than being somewhat too aggressive."
Source: ("Access" podcast Sep 2025)

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Satya Nadella ~ CEO Microsoft

"For this not to be a bubble by definition, the benefits need to be spread much more evenly... A telltale sign of if it's a bubble would be if all we are talking about are the tech firms."
Source: (World Economic Forum Davos, Jan 2026)

Sundar Pichai ~ CEO Google Alphabet

"I think no company is going to be immune... So I think it's both rational and there are elements of irrationality through a moment like this."
Source: (BBC Nov 2025)

Yann LeCun ~ Chief AI Scientist META

"LLMs are not in a bubble in terms of the value of investment – they will power many useful apps and justify big infrastructure efforts. The bubble is believing LLMs alone will reach human level intelligence."
Source: (FT Future of AI Summit Nov 2025)

Ken Griffin ~ CEO Citadel

"The hype is real — and it's there to justify enormous spending."
Source: World Economic Forum Davos, Jan 2026,

Jamie Dimon ~ CEO JPMorgan Chase

"AI is real, AI in total will pay off. But some of the money going into it now will probably be wasted."
Source: BBC, CNN Okt 2025

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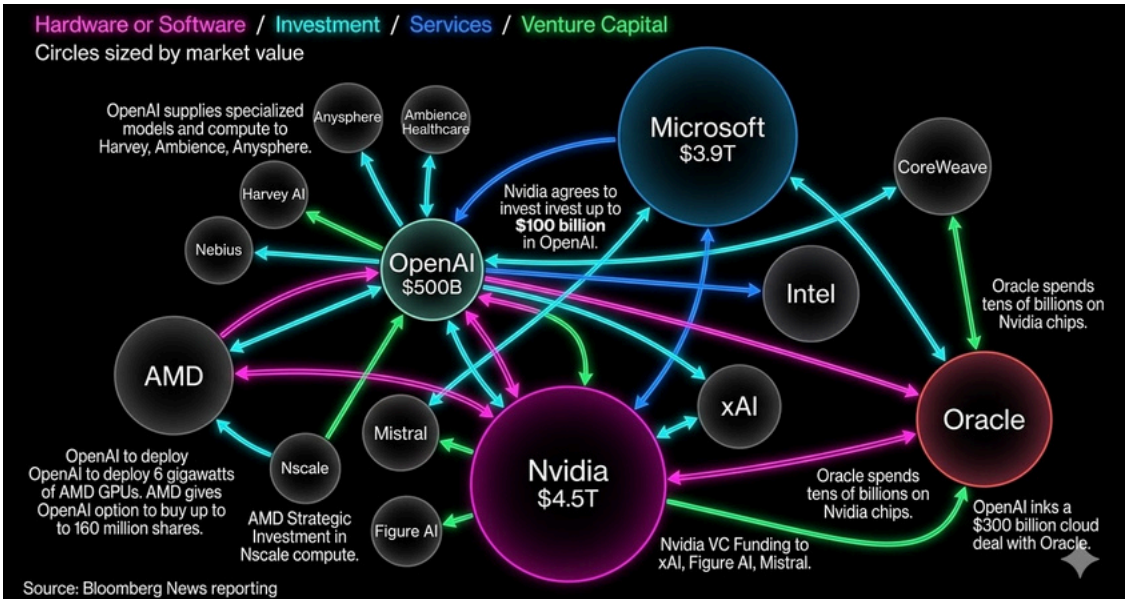
Conclusion

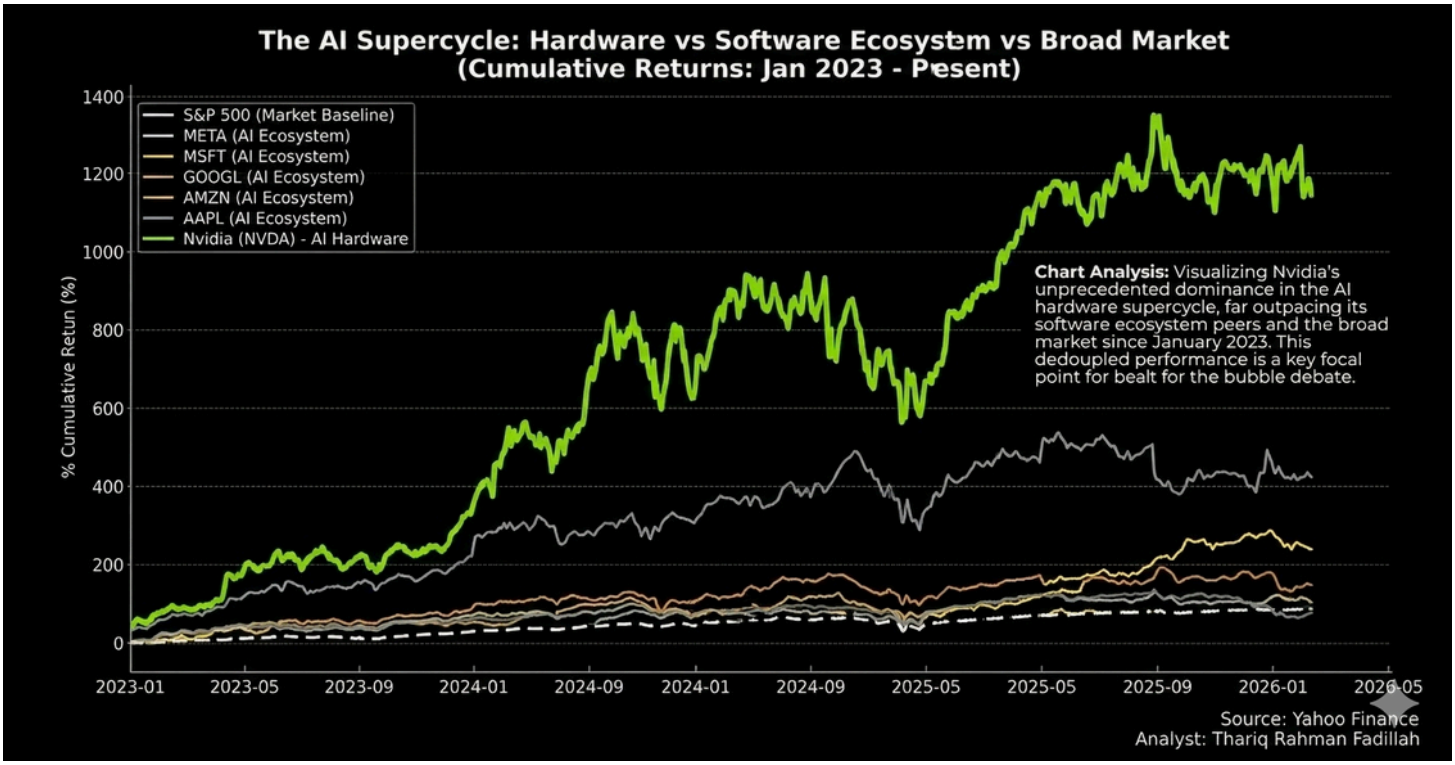
"Synthesizing the perspectives of these 19 influential figures—spanning expansionist, skeptic, and centrist views—it is evident that while AI is an undeniably revolutionary force with generational transformative potential akin to electricity or the internet, the market in early 2026 exhibits clear speculative characteristics. Despite overvaluations and excessive hype suggesting a dot-com-style correction, the underlying technology remains resilient. Core infrastructure leaders like NVIDIA, Microsoft, and Google are poised to emerge significantly stronger from any market purge, as the greater strategic risk lies in under-indexing on AI rather than capital over-allocation."

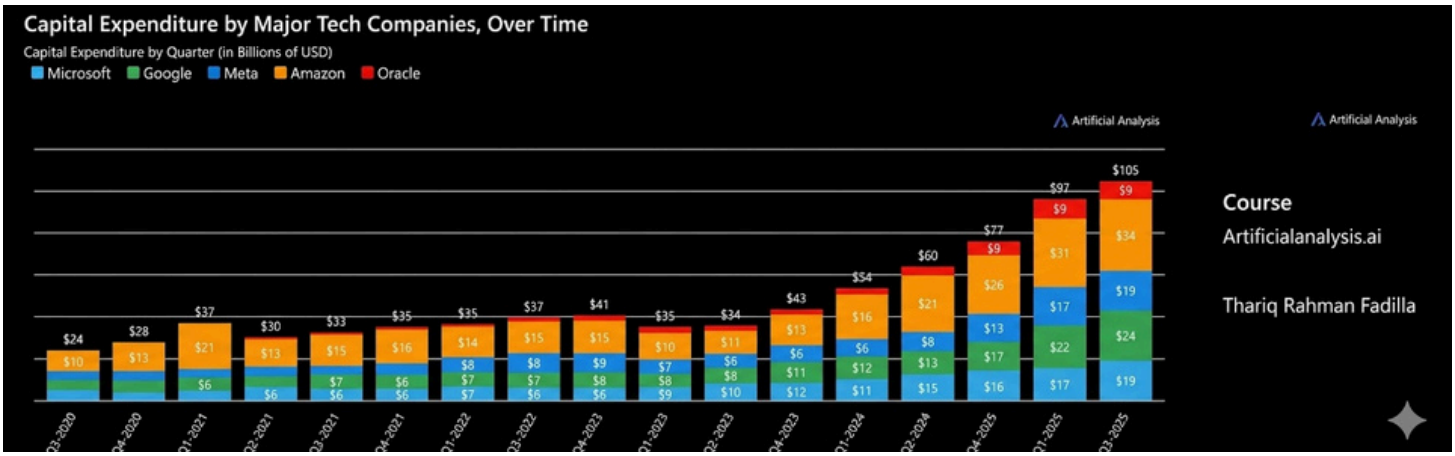
The Data



The network diagram illustrates the highly interconnected and circular capital flow within the current AI ecosystem, where massive valuations and strategic investments tightly bind major tech infrastructure providers and AI developers. At the core of this macro landscape, titans like Nvidia ($4.5T), Microsoft ($3.9T), and OpenAI ($500B) form a symbiotic loop of hardware supply, cloud services, and venture capital, exemplified by Nvidia's massive $100 billion investment agreement in OpenAI and Oracle's multi-billion dollar expenditures on Nvidia chips. This heavy concentration of capital cascades down into strategic partnerships and funding for emerging startups like xAI, Mistral, and Figure AI, highlighting an aggressive environment where tech giants are locking in compute power to dominate the pathway to AGI, which simultaneously fuels the ongoing debate about an overheated, bubble-like capex cycle.

"I have presented this chart in an enlarged format to facilitate precise data interpretation."





Capital Expenditure of major technology companies from the third quarter of 2020 through the third quarter of 2025. The data is measured in billions of USD and includes major players like Microsoft, Google, Meta, Amazon, and Oracle. The chart clearly illustrates a significant and consistent upward trend in spending over this five-year period. Total quarterly capital expenditure grew from $24 billion in Q3 2020 to a projected peak of $105 billion by Q3 2025. Amazon consistently shows the largest share of expenditure throughout the years shown, with its spending rising from $10 billion to $34 billion. This dramatic increase across all companies, especially starting around 2023, is widely attributed to the massive investments needed to develop and sustain Artificial Intelligence technologies.

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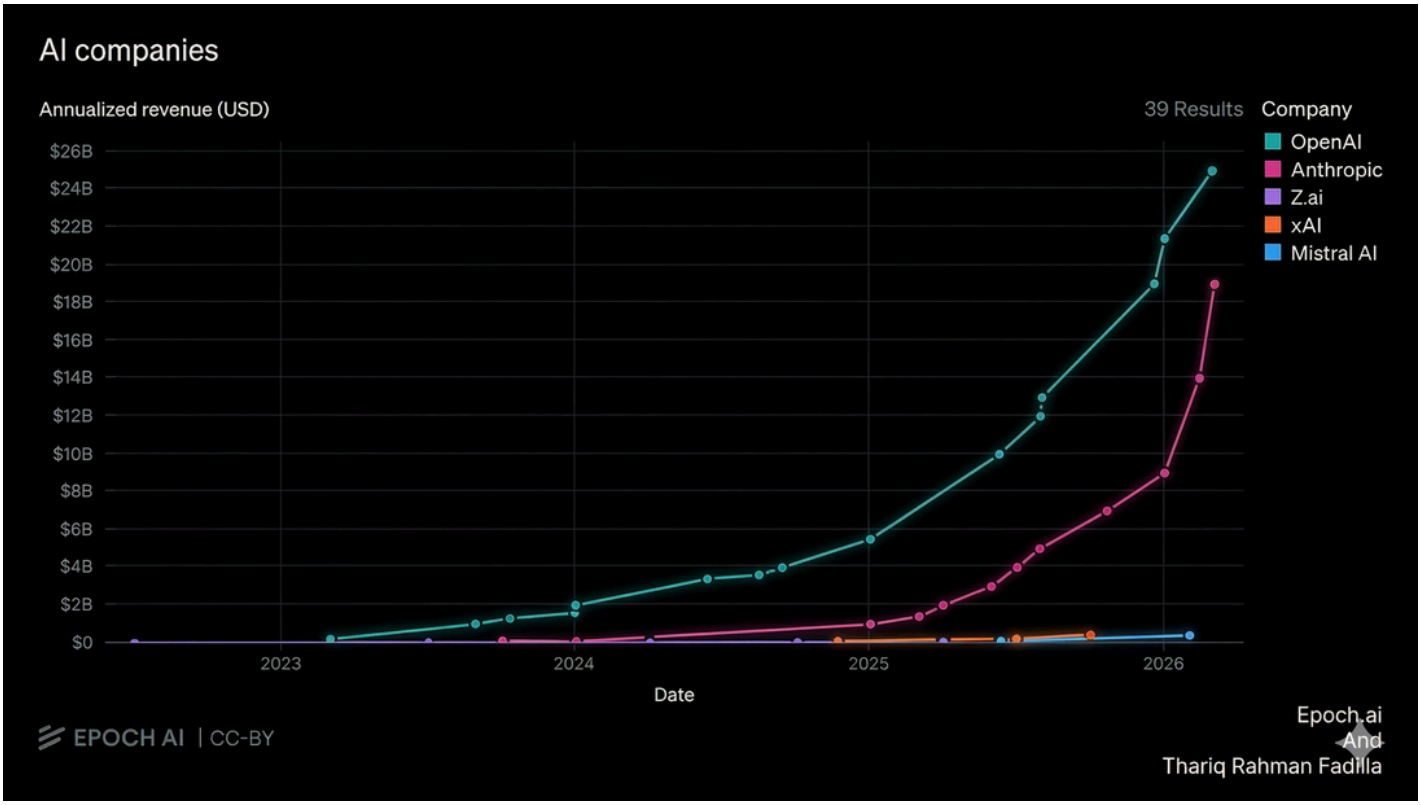

Chart illustrating the annualized revenue growth of five prominent AI companies between late 2022 and early 2026. The chart, sourced from Epoch.ai, tracks the financial performance of OpenAI, Anthropic, Z.ai, xAI, and Mistral AI, measured in billions of USD. The data depicts an overwhelming market dominance by OpenAI, whose revenue experiences an explosive growth trajectory, surging from nearly zero to a massive $26 billion by the beginning of 2026. Anthropic follows as the second-highest earner, showing significant growth to reach approximately $20 billion in the same timeframe. The other three companies—Z.ai, xAI, and Mistral AI—show comparatively flat or slowly increasing revenue lines, staying below the $2 billion mark, highlighting the stark contrast in revenue scale within the rapidly evolving AI sector.

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The widening gap between these two lines confirms that the market rally since early 2023 has been heavily driven by a single dominant asset. This suggests high concentration risk—if liquidity were to leave the AI or NVDA sectors, which are undergoing corrections, the major indices would be much more vulnerable than the underlying market, which is actually moving more moderately.

The News

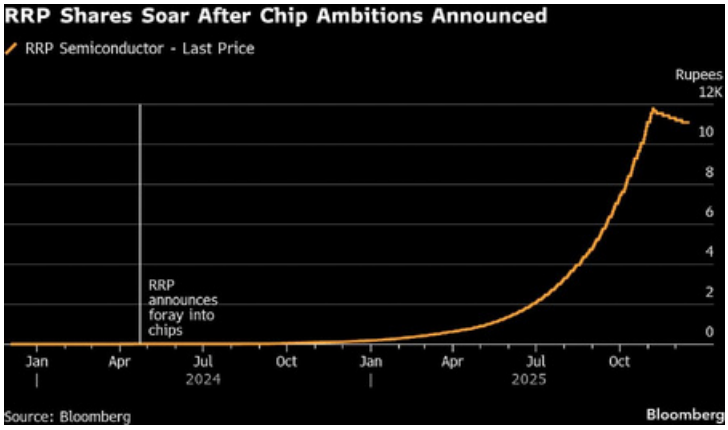
a16z's infrastructure bets

Company	Description
Cursor	AI coding startup now valued at $29.3 billion
Unconventional AI	AI computer startup valued at $4.5 billion in seed round
LMArena	An AI leaderboard platform valued at $1.7 billion
Metronome	Billing platform acquired for reported $1 billion
Regrello	AI platform for manufacturers, acquired by Salesforce
World Labs	AI "world model" developer that raised $230 million in 2024

Source: Bloomberg News Bloomberg

Andreessen Horowitz (a16z) is aggressively doubling down on the AI sector by investing approximately $3 billion into AI infrastructure, firmly dismissing concerns of a market bubble due to high real-world demand and utility. By focusing on software tools for technical buyers—such as the AI coding platform Cursor (now valued at $29.3 billion) and foundational models like those from World Labs—the firm has secured early stakes in high-growth startups before valuations skyrocketed.

Despite acknowledging the "insane" private valuations currently seen in Silicon Valley, a16z leaders argue that the tangible usage of GPUs and the essential nature of these back-end systems justify their massive financial commitments to the future of the technology landscape.



RRP Semiconductor Ltd. in India has emerged as a major warning sign of AI-driven speculation, with its stock price skyrocketing over 55,000% in just 20 months despite reporting negative revenue and employing only two permanent staff members. This meteoric rise was fueled by a pivot from real estate to semiconductors in early 2024, capturing the attention of retail investors hungry for AI exposure in a market with few listed chip companies.

However, with 98% of shares held by a small circle of insiders and the stock recently being restricted to weekly trading, India's market regulator (SEBI) has launched an investigation into potential violations, highlighting the extreme risks and "bubble" characteristics currently appearing in niche segments of the global AI boom.

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Conclusion

"In the early months of 2026, the question is no longer just whether a bubble exists, but whether the underlying 'industrial structure' is robust enough to survive the inevitable speculative correction. As history suggests, the greatest risk may not be over-allocation, but failing to index into the technology currently rewriting the global economy

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About the Author

Thariq Rahman Fadillah is a Quantitative Analyst and Research Engineer specializing in the cryptocurrency market and Artificial Intelligence infrastructure. With a foundational background in Accounting, he integrates rigorous financial principles with data-driven quantitative analysis to dissect macroeconomic shifts

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